

Dance

All over the world and in every culture, people enjoy dancing – moving their bodies to music with a partner, in groups, or solo. People dance to tell stories, express their faith, show their patriotism, keep fit, get ready for battle or sport, celebrate an important event, compete, or purely for fun.

SACRED DANCE

Dance plays an important part in many religions. People include dance in their religious ceremonies or to communicate with their gods.



CORYBANTES
These Ancient Greek priests danced and drummed in armour.



BUDDHISM
Dancing figures are often used to decorate Buddhist shrines.



MUSLIM DERVISHES
Spin themselves into a state of ecstasy, so they can feel closer to god.



NATIVE AMERICANS
Danced to ask the gods for such things as rain or a good harvest.



SIVA NATARAJA
Hindu god Siva is often shown dancing at the creation of the world.

FOLK DANCING

People perform folk dances at festivals and celebrations. The dances are often accompanied by traditional music, and are passed down through generations.



FLAMENCO
A dramatic, rhythmic dance that originated in southern Spain.



ROMA DANCE
Often performed at family weddings and christenings.



LATVIAN DANCE
The Latvian Song and Dance Festival is a huge annual event.



EGYPTIAN DANCING
Ancient Arabic dance, usually performed by a solo woman.



IRISH DANCE
Often performed at competitions, either solo or in teams.



AFRICAN DANCE
African dance is often accompanied by drums and voices.

CLASSICAL DANCE

Classical dance is performed by trained or professional dancers. The focus is on formal steps and poses. These dances usually tell stories from literature or legend.



INDONESIAN
This style, called *bedhaya*, is performed only by women.



CAMBODIAN
A slow style, with smooth, wave-like movements.



KATHAKALI
South Indian dance-drama performed in elaborate make-up.



KABUKI
Japanese theatrical dance performed in colourful costumes.



BALLET
The classical dance form of most Western countries.



BALINESE
A story-telling dance form, always performed barefoot.

DANCE CRAZES

Some dance crazes caused outrage when they first appeared. In the 1780s people were shocked by the waltz because men and women embraced as they danced.

○ CANCAN

The cancan was a lively, high-kicking dance that became wildly popular in the ballrooms and music halls of Paris, France, in the 1830s.

○ JITTERBUG

An energetic, acrobatic couples' dance that originated in the USA in the 1930s. It spread to Europe via American servicemen during World War II.

○ TWIST

The twist was a 1960s craze. There were no steps to learn and no partner needed – dancers just wriggled and twisted along to the music on their own.

○ LINE DANCING

Dancers line up in a row and perform a pattern of steps together to country music. Line dancing started in the USA in the 1970s but became a worldwide craze in the 1990s.

○ GANGNAM STYLE

An overnight dance sensation in 2012 when a video of Korean musician Psy performing his song of the same name went viral.



CANCAN



JITTERBUG



TWIST



LINE DANCING



GANGNAM

BOLLYWOOD STYLE

Bollywood films are famous for song-and-dance routines. In early films, dancers just acted out song lyrics, but the style is now a rich mix that borrows from the many different folk and classical styles of India.

Positions of hands and body tell a story, usually of love



BHARATANATYAM

A classical dance from south India, which features expressive hand movements and poses.



BHANGRA

A Punjabi folk dance, usually accompanied by a strong drum beat.

Both arms are raised during the dance

Kicks and jumps are often used